FREE TEMPLATE · VA 101 EP 22

Scope of Work (Simple)

Agree on this in writing before you start. It protects you and the client, and makes "extra work" easy to talk about.

Client / business _____

Start date _____

Hours and schedule _____

Rate and payday _____

Payment method _____

Main contact channel _____

Included tasks

#	Task	How often / limit
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

Not included (quote separately)

_____

_____

Response time _____

Days off / holidays _____

Notice to end _____

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Polite Boundary Messages

Calm, short and professional. Change the [brackets].

NEW TASK OUTSIDE THE SCOPE

Hi [Name], happy to help with [task]! It's outside our current scope, so here are two options: I can add it for [rate or hours], or we can swap it with [current task] this week. Which works better for you?

TOO MANY URGENT TASKS AT ONCE

Hi [Name], I have [task A] and [task B] due today. Which one should I finish first? I'll do the other one by [time].

MESSAGE OUTSIDE WORKING HOURS

Hi [Name], got it, thanks! I'm offline now and will start on this first thing at [time] your time. If it's an emergency, [what to do].

LATE PAYMENT: FRIENDLY REMINDER (1 TO 3 DAYS LATE)

Hi [Name], quick reminder that the payment for [period] was due on [date]. Could you please check? Thank you!

LATE PAYMENT: FIRM (7+ DAYS LATE)

Hi [Name], the payment for [period] is now [number] days late. I'll need to pause new tasks after [date] until it's settled. I'd love to keep working together, so please let me know when I can expect it.

SAYING NO

Hi [Name], thanks for thinking of me. That's not something I do well yet, so I'd rather not risk your results. I can [alternative] or suggest someone who specialises in it.

On Upwork, keep all payments and contracts on the platform. Never agree to be paid outside it.